SUDHARAK OLWE



NEHA KAMAT / KAMAT FOTO FLASH





KEEPING TIME Clockwise from left, a poster of *Sahib Bibi aur Gulam* (1962); Sunil Dutt among fans; Madhubala and Deepika Padukone

BOLLYWOOD ▼

FRAMES OF FILM **LORE**

AN EXHIBITION IN MUMBAI BRINGS TOGETHER PHOTOGRAPHS, POSTERS, ARTWORKS, FILM STILLS AND MORE AS A TRIBUTE TO INDIAN CINEMA

IT IS NEARLY IMPOSSIBLE TO TELL WHERE MUMBAI ENDS AND BOLLYWOOD BEGINS, and now an exhibition captures that symbiotic relationship, framing the city as both the muse and the backdrop of Indian cinema. *Lens and Legacy: Bollywood in Focus* brings together photographs, artworks, film stills, studio portraits, magazine covers and rare archival material, tracing Bollywood's journey across decades, capturing not just its glamour, but also its emotional depth, cultural shifts, and the many invisible moments that have shaped cinema as we know it today. The visual tribute to Indian cinema is presented by the National Gallery of Modern Art (NGMA), Mumbai, along with the Ministry of Culture, Government of India.

Curated by Shruti Das, deputy curator, NGMA, it features works by respected photojournalists, including Pradeep Chandra, Shantanu Das, Sudharak Olwe and Bandeep Singh, alongside a rare archival showcase curated by noted archivist, author and film historian S.M.M. Ausaja and Neha Kamat of Kamat Foto Flash. A special section features two tribute walls dedicated to Dharmendra and Asha Bhosle.

"Mumbai and Indian cinema have evolved together over more than a century. The city has not merely hosted cinema, it has shaped its language, ambition, aesthetics and cultural imagination," says IAS officer and director of NGMA Mumbai, Nidhi Choudhari, adding that Mumbai today is recognised as a UNESCO Creative City of Films and this exhibition is a celebration of that identity.

For veteran photographer Pradeep Chandra, the exhibition is as much about memory as it is about craft. He shares, "What we shot as simple photographs years ago, with time, they have become important documentation.... A picture of Mr Amitabh Bachchan at RK Studios or Dev Anand at Bombay Central station...today, these moments carry a history that no longer exists. We worked with instinct, composition and available light. Those images now hold a life of their own." ■

—Deepali Dhingra

The exhibition is on till Jun. 30

NOT JUST TRACING BOLLYWOOD'S JOURNEY, THE EXHIBITION CAPTURES ITS EMOTIONAL DEPTH, CULTURAL SHIFTS AND MEMORABLE MOMENTS



BANDEEP SINGH